

LEC18 - Mass Media

Media and Mass Media

Media: Any formats or vehicles that carry, present, or communicate information

Mass Media: Communication technologies that allow for the distribution of information to a mass audience

Structure and Agency

- Structure
 - Structural functionalism
 - Conflict theory
 - Feminist theory
 - Agency
 - Symbolic interactionism
 - Postmodernism
 - Feminist theory
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Audience Effects

Short-term Intended: An immediate and planned impact on the audience

- Ex. A political campaign ad that persuades viewers to vote for a candidate the next day

Short-term Unintended: An immediate but unplanned impact on the audience

- Ex. A violent scene in a movie that leads to an increase in aggressive behaviour among viewers right after watching

Long-term Intended: A gradual and planned impact over time

- Ex. Public health campaigns such as anti-smoking ads that aim to reduce smoking rates over decades

Long-term Unintended: A gradual but unplanned impact over time

- Ex. Social media promoting unrealistic beauty standards, which leads to increased body image issues over years
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Example

Consider body dysmorphia from social media

- Long term unintended
 - Content creators likely didnt intend to cause insecurity

Tuesday, April 1, 2025

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- May also be intended, such as through sponsorships
- Long term because you will see more content that you interact with over the long term
- Can pass down their insecurities to children etc.